

## **OTESSA 2024 Schedule**

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| 12:00 - 1:30   Break . . . . .                                                  | 43 |
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|                                        |    |
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| 7:00 - 11:59   OTESSA Social . . . . . | 50 |
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### **Wednesday, June 12** **52**

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| 8:00 - 9:00   Continental Breakfast Provided . . . . .                          | 52 |
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| 9:00 - 9:15   Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement . . . . | 52 |
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| 12:00 - 1:30   Break . . . . .                                                  | 58 |
| 1:30- 2:30   Keynote . . . . .                                                  | 58 |
| Speaker Forthcoming . . . . .                                                   | 58 |
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| 3:00 - 3:20   Session 3.1 . . . . .                                             | 58 |
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| 7:00 - 11:59   OTESSA Social . . . . .                                          | 61 |

# Daily Schedule

## Note

All times are Eastern Daylight Time

**Current time in Montréal (click for more info)**

## June 12-15 @ McGill University

| Time                | Event                                                      | Location                     | Notes        |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------|
| 6:30 - 7:30 am EDT  | #OTESSA24 Morning Radio Show                               | <a href="#">VoicEd Radio</a> |              |
| 10:30 am - 12:30 pm | Welcome Desk Open                                          |                              |              |
| 10:30 am - 12:30 pm | Conference Welcome, Announcements and LAnd Acknowledgement |                              | LINK         |
| 11:00 am - 12:00 pm | Keynote                                                    |                              | LINK - Jun12 |
|                     |                                                            |                              | LINK - Jun13 |
|                     |                                                            |                              | LINK - Jun14 |
|                     |                                                            |                              | LINK - Jun15 |
| 12:00 - 12:30 pm    | Break                                                      |                              |              |

| Time               | Event                                | Location | Notes                                                                    |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 12:30 - 1:15<br>pm | Parallel Sessions - Invited Speakers |          | LINK -<br>Jun12<br>LINK -<br>Jun13<br>LINK -<br>Jun14<br>LINK -<br>Jun15 |
| 1:15 - 1:30<br>pm  | Break                                |          |                                                                          |
| 1:30 - 3:00<br>pm  | Concurrent Sessions                  |          | LINK -<br>Jun12<br>LINK -<br>Jun13<br>LINK -<br>Jun14<br>LINK -<br>Jun15 |
| 3:00 - 3:45<br>pm  | Break                                |          |                                                                          |
| 3:45 - 5:15<br>pm  | Concurrent Sessions                  |          | LINK -<br>Jun12<br>LINK -<br>Jun13<br>LINK -<br>Jun14<br>LINK -<br>Jun15 |
|                    | Discussion/Networking Pods           |          |                                                                          |
|                    | Congress Events                      |          | LINK                                                                     |
|                    | OTESSA Social                        |          |                                                                          |

**Part I**

**In-Person @ McGill University**

# Wednesday, June 12

 Note!

In Person at McGill University

**8:00 - 9:00 | Continental Breakfast Provided**

**8:00-11:30 | Welcome Desk Open**

**9:00 - 9:15 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement**

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

**9:15 - 9:30 | Break**

**9:30-10:30 | Concurrent Session 1**

**Session 1.1 | Addressing Inequities**

**Card Sorting as a Methodology for Discovering Underlying Needs of Communities Seeking to Develop Learning Spaces: Towards a Better Understanding of the Sociocultural Ecology**

Trottier 0060 (Session A) | Research

Marguerite Koole | *University of Saskatchewan*

Gordon Rugg | *Keele University*

Thiago Lemes de Oliveira | *Wolverhampton University*

**Valentina Arancibia** | *Federal University of Uberlândia*

**Redouane Touati.** | *Universidad Católica del Maule & Yahia Fares University, Médea*

## **i** Abstract

In this paper, we focus on a knowledge elicitation method called single-criterion card sorting. To begin, we will provide a background two of the communities with whom we have been working: a Deaf and Hard of Hearing community in Canada and a community in Algeria. After briefly describing the context of the project, we will provide a description of, rationale for, and challenges with card sorting as a preliminary method. Next, we will explain the card-sorting procedures, present the preliminary data, and explain the analysis procedures. Although there are many kinds of card sorting, we will guide participants through a hands-on exercise using single-criterion card sorting (using both digital and in person techniques). Participants will learn about text-based, image-based, and object-based options, when to use card sorting, how to collect data, and how to analyse card sorting data through visual-numeric ‘heat maps’ (co-occurrence matrices). We can share a free Java-based software tool for generating heat maps.

Put simply, the paper provides a discussion of the data and how the data will guide the selection of subsequent knowledge modelling methods that will guide further analysis and hopefully help to gain a better, in-depth understanding of the communities’ needs and aspirations that may otherwise remain hidden beneath social, cultural, and linguistic barriers. With careful selection of knowledge modelling methods, we hope to help limit bias and the perpetuation of English and Western ways of doing and knowing. Meaningful consultation and collaboration can help to ensure that the communities’ interests remain at the heart of the project(s) and reduce Western (‘outsider’) control of research, analysis, and development.

## **Session 1.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching**

**Evolving our understanding of technology-integrated assessment: A review of the literature and development of a new framework**

**Trottier 2100 (Session C) | Research**

**Colin Madland** | *University of Victoria*

**Valerie Irvine** | *University of Victoria*

**Christopher DeLuca** | *Queens University*

**Okan Bulut** | *University of Alberta*

## **i** Abstract

In this paper, we review the literature on technology in assessment in higher education and compare how the literature aligns with the Assessment in a Digital World framework (Bearman et al., 2022). We found themes in the literature that were not present in the framework (e.g., academic integrity and faculty workload) and constructs in the framework not evident in the literature (e.g., future self and future activities). Additionally, we consider other gaps in both the framework and the literature evident in day-to-day practices and government legislation or mandates, such as considering legal or ethical aspects of duty of care and the integration of Indigenous worldviews. We then developed the Technology-Integrated Assessment Framework to help instructors and administrators consider a broader range of constructs when planning assessment strategies in technology-integrated learning environments and to serve as a basis for further investigation into how the different constructs within the framework contribute to how we design, implement, and teach about assessment in digital learning environments today. We present an introduction of this technology-integrated assessment framework, invite feedback from the OTESSA community, and discuss future research goals and opportunities.

## **Session 1.3 | Addressing Inequities**

### **Critical reflections on course materials: The rise of the single-use e-textbook and a university library's multi-pronged response**

#### **Trottier 2110 (Session D) | Research**

**Madelaine Vanderwerff & Sara Sharun** | *Mount Royal University*

## **i** Abstract

A recent shift by higher education publishers from print to digital content has led to an increase in course instructors adopting digital textbooks and courseware that are rented or sold directly to students. These digital courseware systems are attractive for a number of reasons: they are customizable, contain integrated value-added features, and are often marketed as inclusive, accessible, and cost-saving. However, there is debate about the impact of these tools on student learning and success, and about the challenges they create for learners, including restricting, controlling, and monitoring access and use. Our library has undertaken a number of distinct but related initiatives to support faculty in transitioning away from commercial textbooks in their courses. In this session, we will share a number of initiatives that invite faculty to critically reflect on course material selection, raise awareness about the challenges of commercial textbooks, and offer support for transitioning to OER, freely available, or library-licensed materials in their courses.

This session will share findings from our research and collaboration with stakeholders on campus.

Participants will be invited to share their experiences and discuss the potential long-term impacts of, and responses to, the commercialization and commodification of learning materials on their campuses.

## **10:30-11:00 | Break**

## **11:00-12:00 | Concurrent Session 2 | Ethics in Design Showcase**

All Session 2 Showcases are in the Trottier Mezzanine

### **Showcase 2.1 | Sustaining Positive Change**

#### **Design of Learning Experiences for Cyranoids & Echoborgs**

**Amanda Tkaczyk** | *Independent Scholar*

#### **i Abstract**

Cyranoids are individuals whose communication is determined by another person in real time (Milgram S., 1992). Echoborgs, a subset of Cyranoids, are individuals whose communication is determined by artificial intelligent agents (Corti, K., & Gillespie, A., 2015). With the widespread adoption of generative artificial intelligence tools that will enable the next generation of Echoborgs with highly sophisticated tools to mediate their human-to-human interactions, we are thrilled to explore the design of educational experiences for Cyranoid and Echborg learners. This project will include instructional materials and tools to support the learning and professional development of Echoborgs in your classroom, community, and workplaces. Online attendees can review materials and interact with chatbots. In-person attendees will have the opportunity to engage with a kiosk of learning materials and practice their interactions with a live Echborg learner. This critical design project will present an exploration of how the future of education might adapt in response to AI-augmented & AI-dependent learners. We will explore themes of technology adoption, responsibility, ethics, equity, and care in this speculative educational design project.

## Showcase 2.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

### Artifacts from the Futures of Higher Education

Elisa Arnold, Rocio Chavez Telleria & Laura Viselli | *eCampus Ontario*

#### Abstract

How we think about the future informs the decisions we make today; however, it is sometimes difficult to imagine what the future might look like. Foresight is a discipline and methodology that helps us think systematically about possible ways the future might play out and expands the solution space. Experiential futures, a subset of foresight methodology, is a way to consider different possible futures by interacting with imagined objects or environments of the future and develops capacity for futures thinking.

The Research and Foresight team at eCampusOntario has created four artifacts, grounded in foresight methodology, capturing different ways one can think about technology in higher education. These artifacts are based on the team's foresight trend research and explore possible future roles of technology. To facilitate the discussion and support analysis, we will use a foresight informed discussion toolkit developed by our team. This workshop will introduce attendees to the methodology of experiential futures to advance their capacity for futures thinking.

## Showcase 2.3 | Addressing Inequities

### Generative Friction: A Chatbot Interface Experiment

Ben Taylor & Devon Mordell | *McMaster University*

#### Abstract

Faced with the rapid adoption of generative artificial intelligence (GAI) in everyday life, educators are working to envision the role of this technology and routinely navigating its ethical use. Although the broader social, cultural, and environmental costs of the technology are well-documented, they are normally obscured by digital user interface experiences that “just work.” The practice-based design exhibit we are proposing is a GAI chatbot application that intentionally disrupts the user interface with details about the effects of each text input and output beyond the surface of the computer screen. Drawing on critical interface analyses, speculative design methods, and an interrogation of dark design patterns, we will attempt to make visible the past and potential future effects of GAI, including resource consumption, exploitative labour practices, perpetuation of biases, and an increase in economic divides. During this session, we will demo the

application and then allow for full audience engagement with the exhibit as we speak to the documentation of our design process. Our intention is to introduce a thoughtful and generative friction into the chat interaction, reclaiming so-called malicious techniques (e.g., distraction, interruption, obfuscation, and shock) to playful and socially productive ends.

## Showcase 2.4 | Addressing Inequities

### Decolonizing Educational Design: Toward Justice by Design in Higher Education

Rebecca Sweetman & Yasmine Djerbal | *Queen's University*

#### Abstract

As institutions commit to strategic initiatives for justice in higher education, this session shares practical ways to walk the decolonial talk in the design of education. Delving into critical design as a transformative tool and pedagogy, we seek to shift how storytellers in higher education craft their narratives. This presentation confronts how we, practically, design an equitable future of learning, including the applied skills required to recognize and challenge our normative biases and design assumptions, and transform our day-to-day work in educational design.

Examining how to mitigate curricular harms and consider the ethics of educational technologies, we introduce a justice by design framework that strategically dismantles oppressive, racist, and colonial epistemologies that unconsciously make their way into course design. Through this presentation, we practice design justice principles and share an open professional training curriculum called “[Activist Design in Educational Multimedia](#)” as an opportunity for intervention. The curriculum employs theoretical and practical techniques to develop the competencies and confidence of educational design professionals to apply an anti-oppressive lens in their work. This session presents a multifaceted, practical, and principled approach to critical design that can be integrated across roles, disciplines, and hierarchies to re-story the process and outcomes of educational design.

**12:00 - 1:30 | Break**

**1:30- 2:30 | Keynote**

**Speaker Forthcoming**

**3:00 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 3 | Sustaining Positive Change**

**Trottier 0060 (Session A)**

**3:00 - 3:20 | Session 3.1**

**Supporting OER Adoptions through Federated Discoverability**

**Practice**

**Don Eldridge | *eCampus Ontario***

**i Abstract**

A key aspect of supporting OER adoption remains OER discoverability, which is commonly reported as a barrier to OER adoption as part of finding relevant resources and the time required to adopt (Belikov, & Bodily, 2016; Lantrip & Ray, 2021). This open data initiative includes the development of a metadata schema with crosswalks, technical configurations using Open Archives Initiative Protocol for Metadata Harvesting, and a collaborative pilot project to test and implement the technical solution. At the time of this proposal submission, the initiative is federating out the library metadata records to 24 post-secondary institutions. Lessons learned include working with consortiums and shared technology services, evaluating the value of federation for a wide range of post-secondary institutions, and the impact for future collaborations.

**3:25 - 3:45 | Session 3.2 | Sustaining Positive Change**

**Means to an End? Ethical Methodologies for Developing Ethical Facial Recognition Training Datasets**

**Research**

**Jin Sol Kim, Amanda Yu, Lai-Tze Fan & Tatum Weicker-O'Connor | *University of Waterloo***

## **i** Abstract

In January of 2020, The New York Times published a report on the implications of Clearview AI's facial recognition system in law enforcement. However, unlike other discussions of facial recognition in this field, which focus on the consequences of racial biases within the system, this report revealed the problematic methodology behind the development of Clearview AI's robust training dataset, calling for an examination of ethics in the very process of creating ethical tech. Clearview AI has since been banned in countries including Canada for scraping over three billion photos from social media platforms, breaching privacy laws surrounding consent for use of personal data. Yet the challenge remains: how can we create a fair and robust training dataset for facial recognition algorithms given the resource-intensive nature of the task as well as complications such as the limitations of data privacy? How can we ensure that the means of creating ethical facial recognition technologies mirror its ends? With current rapid developments in generative AI, synthetic training datasets have newly emerged as a promising player in the field of facial recognition technologies. Training datasets such as Digi-Face 1M that are entirely composed of generated images seem to waive the need for ethical considerations altogether by skirting the use of human subjects. Nevertheless, insofar as the application of these tools affect human lives, we must question whether this new method of dataset development is truly free from ethical concerns.

**3:45 - 4:00 | Break**

**4:00 - 4:30 | Concurrent Session 4**

**Session 4.1 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching**

**Trottier 2100 (Session C)**

**Planning, living, and adding to our plates: : K-3 educators' experiences of curricula in Virtual Learning Environments (VLE)**

**Practice Melissa Bishop | *University of Prince Edward Island***

## **i** Abstract

Virtual Learning Environments (VLE) have interested scholars since the late 20th century, with much of the research focusing on secondary and post-secondary instructors and learners (Brown, 2010; Dabbagh, 2007; Fuchs, 2014; Plump & LaRosa, 2017; Proserpio

& Gioia, 2007). With the onset of VLEs in elementary education due to the COVID-19 pandemic and the continuation of synchronous virtual learning thereafter, VLEs have become commonplace in K-3 contexts across Ontario. Yet, as we contend with the ubiquitous nature of technology in early elementary, a paucity of literature exists regarding teachers' and Early Childhood Educators' (ECE) experiences of planned and lived curricula (Muldong et al., 2021; Aperribai et al., 2020; Ferdig et al., 2020) in VLEs. Starting from standpoint epistemologies (Au, 2012; Harding, 1991; Haraway, 2003), reflecting on five narrative interviews, and employing a narrative analysis of field texts (Clandinin, 2006; Clandinin & Connelly, 1988, 1996, 2000), we unearthed six narrative threads: time, parent communication, relationship building, classroom community, engagement and teacher presence, and technological challenges. These six threads suggested how ECEs and teachers navigated the entanglements of planned and lived curricular experiences in VLEs. Further, the five threads exposed critical elements to be considered in future VLE policy and curricular reform in the K-3 context.

## Session 4.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

### Tech-based teaching practices and student engagement from the perspective of self-determination theory

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

Géraldine Heilporn, Mourad Majdoub & Fatme Diab | *Université Laval*

#### Abstract

Teachers can enhance inclusion and provide personalized learning experiences for students by utilizing digital tools and prioritizing inclusive teaching methods (Kim et al., 2019). However, Cabellos et al. (2023) have argued that digital resources were used more to transmit information than to engage students in their learning. The widespread and necessary use of ICT has not served to make learning student-centered but was primarily aimed at the transmission and evaluation of the content. Thus, students' motivation and engagement are significantly affected, worsening the existing issues regarding low school motivation, especially in secondary school (Cai et al., 2022). In response to these research gaps, the aim of this communication is to explore high school teachers' technology-based teaching methods that motivate and address the needs of learners with the use of technology based on the digital divide framework (Van Dijk, 2020), SDT (Self-Determination Theory) (Ryan & Deci, 2017) and student engagement model (Archambault et al., 2019). We have conducted individual semi-structured interviews with high school teachers aiming to obtain in-depth qualitative data mainly through open-ended questions. A thematic analysis has been employed to inductively analyze the interview data and generate pos-

sible themes and categories based on the objectives of our study. The findings and recommendations for future research will be shared at OTESSA conference.

## **Session 4.3 | Sustaining Positive Change**

### **Open Learning Design in an Inquiry-based Educational Setting**

#### **Research**

**Trottier 0070 (Session B)**

**Maryam Shirdel Pour & Michael Paskevicius** | *University of Victoria*

#### **i Abstract**

Inquiry-based learning as a pedagogical approach encourages students to explore and investigate real-world problems and foster a deeper understanding of concepts as they actively connect new information to their existing mental frameworks (Martell, 2022). Educators are increasingly recognizing the value of creating an engaged learning environment that promotes collaboration and allows for personalized and meaningful learning experiences (Bui & Khuu, 2020). Inquiry-based learning may require that learners engage in networking beyond formal academic settings and connect with professionals, peers, and resources in various fields that could foster their deeper engagement with learning (Robert, 2022).

Open Educational Practices (OEP) tend to create cooperative teaching and learning practices in which the focus is on the role of the learners and the impact that their participation will have on the learning process and practice (Mayrberger, 2020; DeRosa & Robinson, 2017; Author. 2019). Students could benefit from the principles of OEP to engage in open and dynamic conversations to collectively build a deeper understanding of the subject and share their ideas and inquiry work widely while following copyright guidelines. This study, therefore, aspires to investigate the effects of incorporating OEP in an educational environment centred around inquiry.

**5:00 - 7:00**

**See Congress Programming for Social Tent & Food Options**

**7:00 - 11:59 | OTESSA Social**

# Thursday, June 13

 Note!

In Person at McGill University

**8:00 - 9:00 | Continental Breakfast Provided**

**8:00-11:30 | Welcome Desk Open**

**9:00 - 9:15 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement**

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

**9:15 - 9:30 | Break**

**9:30-10:30 | Concurrent Session 5**

**Session 5.1 | Addressing Inequities**

Trottier 0060 (Session A) | Practice (French)

**Franchir les obstacles : Améliorer l'accessibilité grâce aux ressources éducatives libres dans l'apprentissage intégré au travail**

Andrea Krasznai | *eCampus Ontario*

## Abstract

Le projet d'apprentissage expérientiel d'eCampusOntario, le Consortium d'apprentissage expérientiel francophone de l'Ontario (CAPFO), rassemble les institutions postsecondaires francophones et bilingues de l'Ontario pour combler une lacune : le manque d'opportunités d'apprentissage expérientiel dans les environnements francophones et bilingues. En utilisant la plateforme Riipen, nous offrons aux membres du CAPFO la possibilité d'augmenter le nombre d'opportunités disponibles pour leurs apprenants au-delà des frontières géographiques de la province.

Dans le cadre de ce projet, une nouvelle lacune a été mise en lumière : le manque de ressources en français pour les professeur.e.s souhaitant s'impliquer dans l'apprentissage intégré au travail. eCampusOntario a créé des ressources éducatives libres (REL) pour soutenir les professeur.e.s dans le développement de leurs connaissances en matière d'apprentissage intégré au travail. De plus, une enquête de recherche a été menée dans le secteur francophone de l'Ontario pour dévoiler les tendances et les défis, désormais disponibles sous forme de rapport REL dans la bibliothèque ouverte d'eCampusOntario, la plus grande bibliothèque ouverte au Canada.

Au cours de notre session, nous fournirons des informations sur ce qu'est le CAPFO et mettrons en lumière les exigences particulières de la communauté minoritaire franco-ontarienne engagée dans l'apprentissage intégré au travail (AIT). Nous aborderons ensuite les ressources éducatives libres (REL), comment elles peuvent améliorer l'expérience des professeur.e.s dans l'AIT et dévoilerons quelques conclusions clés de notre rapport. Finalement, nous fournirons à notre public un guide REL afin qu'ils puissent initier l'expérimentation et la création de leurs propres REL.

## Session 5.2 | Wildcard

### Trottier 0070 (Session B) | Practice

#### 9:30 - 10:30 | Unveiling the Future of Language Teaching and Acquisition: Exploring the Conflation of Cultural Historical Activity Theory, and Generative AI

Tanya Dixit & Michael Paskevicius | *University of Victoria*

## Abstract

Contemporary technology trends in education are profoundly reshaping the design of teaching and learning languages. This trajectory, Li (2017) observes, can be largely attributed to the “development of learning theories and pedagogical considerations” (p.3) alongside several other contributing factors, a sentiment echoed by Blake (2009) and

Heift and Chapelle (2012) who confirm the far-reaching influence and potential of CALL, which further offers substantial promise to refine and enhance second language (L2) acquisition. Moreover, these scholars unanimously agree that technology integration and implementation should be firmly grounded in research built upon theoretical foundations. Hence, conjoining Cultural Historical Activity Theory (CHAT) (Engeström, 1987) and the affordances of generative AI, exemplified by ChatGPT, this presentation looks at transformative opportunities in which current AI bots can reform classroom teaching-learning discourse. This comprehensive awareness about AI's potentiality to revamp instructional methods, improve learner engagement, and offer avenues for personalizing and differentiating instruction is to be deemed essential not only for equipping stakeholders with the knowledge to navigate the nuances and challenges inherent in optimizing language acquisition experiences, but also to set the stage for a future where learners and educators can seamlessly integrate cutting-edge tools and technologies into improving the language acquisition experience.

#### **10:00 - 10:30 | Personalized learning path in a course on digital technology for secondary education programs**

**Géraldine Heilporn, Alexandre Lepage, Audrey Raynault & Julie Chamberland |**  
*Université Laval*

##### **i Abstract**

This communication presents the new design of a course on digital technology for teaching and learning, offered to students enrolled in secondary education programs at Laval University (Quebec), based on the concept of adaptive learning. Following a diagnostic assessment questionnaire of their digital competency at the beginning of the semester, students are automatically assigned to three thematic activities aimed to develop their digital competency for transfer to secondary education. After working on a thematic activity for one week, students return to the classroom for peer-to-peer teaching and learning on these thematic activities, in a blended course modality alternating asynchronous (thematic activities) and synchronous classes (peer-to-peer teaching and learning). Temporary thematic support communities as well as disciplinary learning communities are set to encourage peer collaboration and support throughout the semester. At given time-points during the semester, students also have to assess their peer collaboration and give them feedback a peer evaluation mechanism.

#### **Session 5.3 | Sustaining Positive Change**

**Trottier 2100 (Session C)**

## 9:30 - 10:30 | Developments in National OER Advocacy in Canada

**Ann Ludbrook** | *Toronto Metropolitan University*

**Michael McNally** | *University of Alberta*

### Abstract

This 50-minute session builds upon the Canadian Association Research Libraries (CARL)'s National Advocacy Framework for Open Educational Resources (OER) in Canada (2023). It updates attendees on national OER advancements, and features insights from the Indigenous Knowledges and OER summit held in Vancouver in February 2024. The summit produced principles for working with Indigenous knowledges in OER, alongside discussions on progressing national OER advocacy. The session covers developments in policy, infrastructure, and francophone OER stemming from summits in 2022 and 2023. Reports from these events will be discussed, along with updates on ongoing federal budget consultations and the anticipated 2025 federal election. The audience will also have the opportunity to contribute ideas and strategies for national advocacy, via group discussion and polls.

## 10:30-11:00 | Break

## 11:00-12:00 | Concurrent Session 6 | Ethics in Design Showcase

All Session 6 Showcases are in the Trottier Mezzanine

### Showcase 6.1 | Sustaining Positive Change

#### Redesigning Computing for Openness - the Ethics of Consuming Devices

**Brian Sutherland** | *University of Toronto*

### Abstract

Have you started to accumulate old computing devices? Why does the logic of computing involve repeated purchase and consumption of expensive “molded plastic epics” (Gabrys, 2011)? Thinking back on calculation devices and this ethical problem of repeated consumption, the simple solar calculator stands out for its durability – an energy harvesting strategy that doesn’t use batteries, and it doesn’t wear out. Fifty year old solar powered calculators and other electronic devices which still work may be found. In

this session, proposed for the Ethics in Design Conference Strand, I will review the history of energy harvesting information devices and their significant characteristics around sustainability, present response designs which engage various ethical questions around consumption, carbon production and degrowth, and discuss their usefulness as open designs and thought-artifacts in an iterative speculative design conversation around climate change.

## Showcase 6.2 | Sustaining Positive Change

### A framework and model for engagement in open, online spaces

Michelle Harrison | *Thompson Rivers University*

Michael Paskevicius | *University of Victoria*

#### Abstract

This design case provides an analysis of the creation of an innovative open educational practices (OEP) project “Rethink Learning Design”, designed to explore and implement critical approaches to learning and instructional design. We recognized that if we want to embrace the power of OEP to change teaching and learning practice we need to enable spaces that honor multiple voices and perspectives, co-create knowledge and challenge traditional roles and hierarchies supported in open pedagogical approaches. Two key goals guided our project: the development of a reader/resource based on open pedagogy principles, emphasizing inclusivity and participation, and the integration of a reflective practice framework to deepen engagement and bring about a shift in educational practices. In this session and design case we will outline our iterative design process, ethical considerations, and theoretical foundations, and student use and feedback, with the aim of sharing insights and templates for practitioners in diverse educational contexts. We will consider how we can approach design as a theory of action and consider ways to promote learner ownership, open scholarship, anonymity, and options for permanence through our learning design tool.

## Showcase 6.3 | Addressing Inequities

### Cultural Dimensions of Ethics in Design: Indigenous Knowledge & Online Course Media

Brian Lorraine | *Simon Fraser University*

## **i** Abstract

This session delves into the intricate design process of an online Indigenous Ethnozoology course, exploring the tensions, challenges, and ethical considerations encountered during an 8-month redesign and development period. Originally authored by a Squamish knowledge holder, the course featured recorded lectures intertwining oral histories with western scientific perspectives. The transition to a new instructor, a professor of white settler descent, prompted critical reflection on retaining Indigenous knowledge while improving instructional effectiveness. Drawing on cognitive load theory and empirical studies on video engagement, the design team navigated the complexities of honoring oral traditions while enhancing student learning experiences. This case study highlights the necessity for robust frameworks addressing Indigenous knowledge protocols in educational design, underscored by ongoing critical reflection to confront colonial legacies and promote ethical practices.

## **Showcase 6.4 | Addressing Inequities**

### **Moving Towards Design Justice through Multivocal Design in Health Education**

**Danielle Dilkes** | *University of Western Ontario*

## **i** Abstract

This Design Case features an interprofessional stroke care case for health and medical education that was developed through a participatory design process. The objectives of the case were to highlight the complexities of interprofessional care and prepare learners for interprofessional practice. The approach to developing this case draws on key Design Justice principles: those most impacted by a design should be central in the design process and that various types of expertise exist and have value. The stroke care case was co-developed with patients, or Lived Experience Experts (LEEs), and all members of an interdisciplinary stroke care team, or Subject Matter Experts (SMEs). Patients were invited to share their real experience of stroke care, which became the basis of the case. Each health care professional was given full control over how their roles were portrayed, and invited to craft and star in their scenes within the case. This process resulted in a multivocal media rich case that more accurately reflects real patient experience and the real scope of practice for different health professionals. In our Design Case Exhibit, we will share multimedia components of the final case, but we will also share design knowledge in support of a more general framework for participatory design that could account for some of the complications of co-design across institutional roles.

**12:00 - 1:30 | Break**

**1:30 - 2:15 | Concurrent Session 7**

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

**Session 7.1 | Sustaining Positive Change**

**An e-Book of One's Own: Empowering Student Learning Journeys**

Practice

**Terry Greene & Christian Metaxas** | *Trent University*

**i** Abstract

Join our interactive session to explore the transformative initiative, “An e-Book of One’s Own,” designed to reshape the student experience in higher education. In a dynamic environment, participants will engage with Pressbooks, a powerful tool enabling students to craft personalized e-books showcasing their academic journey. The session emphasizes hands-on exploration, collaborative problem-solving, and interactive structures to work towards successful implementation. Reflective exercises simulate the student experience, fostering a deep understanding of the program’s impact. This session is not a passive presentation; it’s a collective effort to redefine educational experiences. Attendees will leave with practical insights, strategies for implementation, and a renewed vision for empowering students through digital innovation.

**Session 7.2 | Wildcard & Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching**

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

**1:30 - 1:50 | Triads to Complete Capstone: e-Portfolios**

Practice

**Christine Ho Younghusband** | *University of Northern British Columbia*

### **i** Abstract

For one graduate program at a small research university in British Columbia, completing a digital portfolio is one option for capstone to demonstrate learning and conclude the program. The portfolio option includes developing a WordPress site, articulating one's learning through the lens of a guided question, and a presentation of the portfolio to a committee. The student and committee members are led by a faculty supervisor. Completion of this capstone can be an isolating experience. In one term, two graduate students were left without a supervisor and needed to complete the program that term. One faculty member supervised three graduate students at one time. Over time, the three graduate students formed a triad, or small learning community, where they supported, peer-assessed, and collaborated in an ongoing way to complete their portfolios. The outcomes were personalized and unique to the learner. This presentation is a program evaluation that investigates the value and impact of triads during capstone and portfolio to invite back humanity into the capstone and portfolio experience.

## **1:55 - 2:15 | Using AI to design a Culturally Responsive STEM course and improve sense of belonging among students**

### **Research**

**Nahid Pourdolat Safari & Behnoosh Khoramrooz** | *University of Victoria*

### **i** Abstract

This session aims to explore the integration of AI in Culturally Responsive Teaching (CRT) to enhance the sense of belonging in STEM education. Focusing on the importance of CRT in developing a sense of belonging and as a result, in enhancing motivation, engagement, persistence and academic performance, this presentation will discuss the theoretical foundations of CRT and explore implementing AI-generated content in STEM course design to foster a more inclusive learning environment. This session will delve into how AI can validate and acknowledge students' cultural backgrounds in STEM classes with a focus on underrepresented groups, including Indigenous, Black and international students. By showcasing practical examples, this session intends to demonstrate how AI technologies can be used to motivate and engage STEM students from diverse cultural backgrounds by improving their sense of belonging.

**2:15 - 2:45 | Break**

**2:45 - 3:45 | Unconference**

**3:45 - 4:00 | Break with Coffee & Snack Provided**

**4:00 - 4:30 | Concurrent Session 8**

**Session 8.1 | Addressing Inequities**

**Trottier 2100 (Session C)**

**Survivors of Complex Trauma as Adult Online Learners**

**Research**

**Hilary Schmidt | *Thompson Rivers University***

**i Abstract**

Complex trauma is both a product and a source of significant multidimensional inequality, including profound disruption to survivors' educational trajectories. Nonetheless, little research has been conducted on trauma-informed educational practices for adult/postsecondary or open/online learners, and educational researchers have largely ignored the perspectives of survivors, contradicting the key principle of collaboration within a trauma-informed approach.

This qualitative instrumental collective case study explored how adults with a history of complex trauma experience postsecondary open/online learning. Findings included participants' struggles with executive functioning, challenges regulating emotion and dealing with a heightened perception of threat, re-experiencing trauma, negative beliefs about the self, and difficulties navigating relationships. These trauma impacts affected not only participants' learning and course experience, but also their experience of applying, registering, and accessing financial aid. Nonetheless, participants are demonstrably skilled in managing impacts of their trauma and are driven to learn, placing the highest intrinsic value on education. Top priorities for implementation of trauma-informed educational practices identified by participants included establishing safety; trust and transparency; and empowerment, voice, and choice. Implications are discussed, including enhancing equity and inclusion for survivors of complex trauma and assisting open/online postsecondary institutions in meeting their unique needs through implementation of trauma-informed educational practices.

## Session 8.2 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

### Protecting Indigenous Knowledge in Open Education

Don Eldridge & Mary Gu | *eCampus Ontario*

#### Abstract

As open educational practices (OEP) and open educational resources (OER) grants, programs, and initiatives are created by organizations, there is a need to consider the diverse and nuanced Equity, Decolonization, Diversity, and Inclusion (EDDI) issues that will be surfaced. Funding institutions and agencies must consider how their support and promotion of OEP and OER may not support and may even alienate Indigenous members of their community. This presentation will provide an overview of the EDDI concerns faced in a major investment into an OER program in Canada that impacted multiple postsecondary institutions through 3 years of work. This presentation will share the development process of a geographically specific Commons license, the metrics on uptake since the launch of the license, and the impact on supporting digital-by-design virtual learning. This experience can inform the broader open education community by sharing lessons learned and best practices as a case study.

## Session 8.3 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

### Creating Reskilling and Upskilling Opportunities for Internationally Educated Immigrants through Online Learning Programs: The Story of Success

Practice

Marina Grineva | *Intercultural Skills Lab (Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto)*

#### Abstract

The importance of access to reskilling and upskilling opportunities for immigrants can't be overestimated. However, there is a number of challenges that this population faces while trying to integrate into the workforce or advance in their careers in Canadian work

environments. One of such challenges is the inability to attend professional development programs in-person. From this perspective, technology-enhanced learning, specifically, on-line or hybrid learning environments (a combination of asynchronous and synchronous learning sessions) are one of the solutions of the problem.

In this presentation, we aim to provide the overview of professional development programs offered by [The Intercultural Skills Lab](#) (Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto) that successfully provides reskilling and upskilling opportunities for internationally trained immigrants by creating a variety of technology-enhanced learning environments. Specifically, we will demonstrate how through the use of a number of online learning tools the program participants are given an opportunity to become part of vibrant collaborative learning communities fostering professional development in such areas as intercultural intelligence, effective communication, career management, as well as in the sector-specific disciplines.

**5:00 - 7:00**

**See Congress Programming for Social Tent & Food Options**

**7:00 - 11:59 | OTESSA Social**

# Friday, June 14

 Note!

In Person at McGill University

**8:00 - 9:00 | Continental Breakfast Provided**

**8:00-11:30 | Welcome Desk Open**

**9:00 - 9:15 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement**

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

**9:15 - 9:30 | Break**

**9:30-10:30 | Concurrent Session 9**

**Session 9.1 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching**

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

**9:30 - 10:30 | How do students make sense of a Learning Analytic Dashboard? Exploring learners' perceptions and plans**

Research

**Maribel Miller & Emma Graves** | *University of Victoria*

## **i** Abstract

Student-facing learning analytic dashboards (LADs) claim to help students manage their learning. However, many widely available LADs can be inflexible and lack consideration of the contemporary theory and research of learning. Furthermore, it is unclear how students use information presented in LADs and translate it into meaningful action. This descriptive study investigates students' use of a learning analytic dashboard to inform goal-setting and achievement over the course of one week in a large, hybrid undergraduate course. Specifically, we explore (a) learners' evaluations of their course progress after interacting with the LAD (b) types of goals set by students for managing their learning during the week, post-interaction with the LAD; (c) the extent to which learners achieved their goals; and (d) students' perceptions of LAD utility in supporting them to manage their learning. Data were collected through two questionnaires administered at the midpoint of a course. Preliminary findings indicate that after viewing the dashboard, most learners set goals for maintaining their current progress during the week by focusing on their motivation. However, most learners reported failing to fully attain their goal by the end of the week. Implications for supporting learner engagement with LADs students-facing learning analytic dashboards are discussed.

## **10:00 - 10:30 | Building/Belonging: An Exploration of Digital and Place-Based Belonging Practices at [Redacted]**

### **Research**

**Bonnie Stewart** | *University of Windsor*

## **i** Abstract

This presentation overviews a case study of belonging, considered and framed through the lens of both place-based identity and digital education. The case study project under discussion aims to build on the established digital practices of a distributed European higher and further education institution, with multiple regional campuses, which serve to make education accessible and inclusive to a remote population otherwise underserved. The session will present the lit review, design, and goals of the case study project, while exploring ideas of community belonging in traditionally diasporic regions as well as digital belonging in online classrooms. It will explore the affordances and impacts of both, and the ways the two may or may not intersect in this particular context. This project extends the exemplary research and practice being done at this institution with digital technologies, in hopes of making visible the ties between geographic and cultural belonging practices and those that can be amplified and supported digitally. This institution's inclusive and accessible approaches may be of value to the OTESSA audience in a time

when belonging is a need for students in many contexts.

## Session 9.2 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 0070 (Session B) | Practice

### 9:30 - 10:30 | Walk the Walk: Fostering Equitable Practices in Organizational Sustainability

Apurva Ashok & Kaitlin Schilling | *The Rebus Foundation*

#### Abstract

How do equitable practices show up in the workplace? In our pursuit of different goals, we often forget the journey and careful, collective organization it takes to get and hold us there.

In the discourse around building equitable futures, this session makes space to think about organizational sustainability and designing intentional work practices for long-lasting and widespread impact. Our approach extends beyond addressing external stakeholders and emphasizes modeling equitable practices internally — at the individual level and collectively within the organization.

The presentation will delve into the flexible work model we have developed that prioritizes organizational mission and the people and work to implement the mission. Our model looks at goals beyond just profitability and instead asks how we can sustain individuals, foster critical reflection, and create positive organizational change. We will showcase how equitable practices manifest in daily team interactions, board discussions, strategic direction, programming, and resource utilization.

While the principles we embrace are not groundbreaking, they are critical to the welfare and long-term success of an organization. Our focus is intentionally on the often-overlooked aspect of applying equity-minded principles within the organizational context. The presentation aims to cement the significance of iterative daily practices in sustaining a culture of equity and inclusion within educational organizations.

## Session 9.3 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

**9:30 - 10:30 | Is AI for or Against Human Success? An Exploratory Engagement by Female Scholars**

**Practice**

**Judith Pete** | *Tangaza University College*

**Gelareh Keshavarz** | *Athabasca University*

**Jenni Hayman** | *Royal Roads University*

**i Abstract**

In this practice-focused session, an educator from Kenya and two educators from Canada will compare access to and experiences of artificial intelligence (AI) tools for work and education in their professional contexts. Topics will include learner, educator, and institutional access to the Internet and devices in general—and access and use of AI tools, specifically. The presenters will share emerging concerns about the ethics of the design and use of AI tools and share their interests and the positive potential they see for the use of these tools. Participants attending the session will be invited to share their ideas, contexts, interests, and concerns about AI as contributions to group learning. Strategies for ethical and pedagogic review of AI tools will be shared.

**10:30-11:00 | Break**

**11:00-12:00 | Poster Session**

Information forthcoming.

**12:00 - 1:30 | Break**

**1:30 - 2:15 | Concurrent Session 10**

**Session 10.1 | Wildcard**

**Trottier 2100 (Session C)**

## 1:30 - 1:50 | Dangling in Between: Investigating the Impacts of Using AI in Higher Education Research

### Research

Todd Milford & Sara Fallahi | *University of Victoria*

#### Abstract

Artificial intelligence (AI) is used in education since 2015 (Vincent-Lancrin & van der Vlies, 2020). Benefits and hindrances of using AI has been debated in many academic literature (Chen et al., 2020; Crompton & Song, 2021; Verma & Tomar, 2021). Today with the rise of AI tools which are available to the public, with students using them more, and universities clarifying their stance on the topic, investigating the impacts of using AI in education is more crucial than ever. The purpose of this paper is to investigate the impacts of using AI tools for graduate students. For this aim, participants were introduced to a few AI tools to use for writing literature review. Participants were also interviewed on their experience and opinion on using AI in research. Initial findings of this research suggest that the participants could benefit from using AI, for example in saving time while researching, although some concerns remained unsolved for them. The output of this research can be considered while integrating AI in higher education as well as policy making.

## 1:55 - 2:15 | OER in the context of generative AI

### Practice

Normand Roy | *University of Montreal*

#### Abstract

This proposal explores the transformation of OER in the context of Artificial Intelligence (AI), examining the multifaceted relationship between these two domains. While highlighting the potential benefits of AI in personalizing learning, creating new resources, and enhancing accessibility, the proposal also confronts the challenges associated with authorship and ethical considerations of AI-generated content. Focusing on strategies to navigate these challenges while ensuring the integrity of original contributions, the proposal further investigates how advanced AI techniques like fine-tuning and Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG) can be employed to create highly adaptive and personalized OER aligned with learners' needs. Additionally, it explores the potential of AI in generating multimodal resources, potentially overcoming language, literacy, and learning preference barriers to broaden access to education globally. Ultimately, this proposal

aims to leverage AI while addressing its inherent challenges, ultimately enhancing the quality, accessibility, and adaptivity of OER.

## Session 10.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

### 1:30 - 1:50 | Undergraduate Students as Research Partners: Lessons Learned in a Scoping Review of Social Media in Teaching and Learning

Research

Emma Duke, Linh Bui, & Richard Hayman | *Mount Royal University*

#### Abstract

After 20+ years of educators incorporating various social media into their undergraduate teaching and learning, we have identified the need to critically examine the existing body of literature on social media integration in higher learning to understand how this use has been studied as well as how it informs today's teaching and learning processes. This presentation reports on our scoping review project exploring trends, gaps, and issues in the use of social media technologies in undergraduate teaching and learning contexts. The researchers, including two undergraduate student research partners, will refer to the project protocol (author3 & author4, 2023) and present initial findings and lessons learned during the project to-date. We will also discuss meta-research implications from these initial findings, including an exploration of partnering with undergraduate student RAs on a rigorous evidence synthesis project, with the latter delivered primarily from the perspective of the student partners.

### 1:55 - 2:15 | Flexibility and Foresight in Ontario Postsecondary Education: Voices from the Field

Practice

Elisa Arnold, Rocio Chavez Telleria & Laura Viselli | *eCampusOntario*

#### Abstract

Flexibility has emerged as a key area to support digital transformation in postsecondary education, and educators are often at the forefront of implementation. To understand

how educators are thinking and feeling, we engaged with 45 educators from Ontario's publicly-supported postsecondary institution through six virtual workshops using foresight methods to frame the conversations. Foresight is a formal, systematic way of thinking about the future, which offers a way to think about how the future might play out and expand the solution space. Specifically, we used the following foresight methods: Futures Triangle, to understand the interrelationships among future visions, present drivers of change, and past limitations; Causal Layered Analysis (CLA), to explore the assumptions that underlie the way we frame problems, situations, and solutions; and Three Horizons, to explore what would it take to transition from present situations to future visions. This presentation is a summary of the research about these educators think and feel about flexibility in post secondary education, including considerations of equity and ethics and the application to practice, policy and infrastructure and recommended next steps.

## 2:15 - 2:45 | Break

## 2:45 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 11

Trottier 0070 (Session B)

### Session 11.1 | Addressing Inequities

#### Challenging Stereotypes: The Role of The Matilda Project in STEM Gender Equality

##### Workshop

Shehroze Saharan | *University of Guelph*

##### Abstract

The Matilda Effect - a term coined by Yale historian Margaret W. Rossiter - is a phenomenon used to describe women scientists who have been ignored, forgotten, or denied credit due to sex-linked biases. The unfortunate reality is that the Matilda Effect is still prevalent today as women are not given due credit for their scientific achievements. The Matilda Project (<https://www.thematildaproject.com/>), a higher education initiative committed to shedding light on the pervasive issue of gender inequality in STEM, stands strategically poised to tackle this challenge. Positioned as an open-access resource, The Matilda Project encompasses the creation of educational videos and a website. The videos offer concise insights into key topics, while the website will host interactive activi-

ties and will serve as a comprehensive collection showcasing both historical and contemporary women scientists who share a common experience—the Matilda Effect.

## Session 11.2 | Sustaining Positive Change

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

### Empowering Student Voices: Integrating Stop-Motion Animation with Google Drawing, Canva, and Cap Cut

Practice

Patricia Dennis | *Pride Academy Charter School*

#### Abstract

In designing Project Based Learning (PBL) curriculum and units that focus on real-world issues related to diversity, sustainability, and justice, students will create hands-on projects that evoke change within themselves, their communities, and globally. In this interactive and engaging in-person workshop, educators will be immersed in a comprehensive session focused on harnessing the potential of stop-motion animation using Google Draw, Canva, and Cap Cut. The central objective of this workshop is to empower educators with the expertise and tools to integrate the engineering design process into their teaching methods, fostering student creativity and innovation while amplifying their voices through modern technology. Throughout the workshop, participants will explore how to utilize Project-Based Learning (PBL) to sustain positive change and explore the UN Global Goals, aiming to equip educators with the necessary resources and strategies to facilitate meaningful learning experiences for their students.

## Session 11.3 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

### 2:45 - 3:45 | Unleashing Potential: Exploring Open Education Initiatives with TRU Open Press

Practice

Danielle Collins, Marie Bartlett, Brenna Gray, Jessica, Kaitlyn Meyers, Jon Fulton, Natasha Ramroop Singh & Ananya Kamboj | *Thompson Rivers University*

### **i** Abstract

Join us at the OTESSA conference as we highlight the transformative impact of the Thompson Rivers University (TRU) Open Press. As proponents of open education, we aim to demonstrate how the TRU Open Press fosters a sustainable and inclusive future through innovative projects. Gain insights into our core operations, including our role as a leading provider in web-first publishing, open pedagogy, and scholarship. We'll delve into our proposal process, detail how projects are initiated and navigated, with the goal of sustaining positive change for a diverse, sustainable, and democratic world. Experience the tangible impact of our initiatives through a showcase of successful projects in the evolving landscape of online learning. Explore our open publication strategies, funding mechanisms, and their profound impact on addressing inequities. Learn about our collaborations with faculty, students, Indigenous communities, and local organizations, all contributing to sustaining shared futures through education. Delve into the production processes of our Open Educational Resources (OER) and open pedagogy projects, fostering positive and meaningful change. Join us in shaping the future of education and scholarship through meaningful discussions and building connections for shared knowledge and inclusivity.

## **3:45 - 4:00 | Break with Coffee & Snack Provided**

## **4:00 - 4:30 | Concurrent Session 12**

### **Session 12.1 | Addressing Inequity**

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

#### **Seeking a newer equity, diversity, and inclusion model for educators**

#### **Practice**

**Lorayne Robertson, Jessica Trinier & Roland Van Oostveen** | *Ontario Tech University*

### **i** Abstract

The complexities of the human condition are evident in myriad ways, yet human differences are used globally to deny basic rights. How differences are perceived in education impacts student access and participation in school, and ultimately the outcomes of their

school experience. Courses on equity, diversity and inclusion are one means to help future educators become aware that the benefits of schooling are not equally available to all students. This paper presents a reflective description of a model used for the co-construction of equity, diversity and inclusion courses that employs a community of practice model where student voice features prominently in both course design and course enactment. The model relies on establishing a shared spirit of equity humility for learners and educators, and recognition of the need for student safety in potentially uncomfortable conversations. Basic human rights is an anchoring concept. While, in the past, the teaching of equity has tended to focus on distinct aspects of oppression in society as individual topics, the co-construction of equity model relies, instead, on building bridges of understanding that cross oppressions. The concept of building cross-equity understandings is helpful as a guide to dismantling oppression and guiding the rebuilding of safer, more inclusive spaces in schools.

## Session 12.2 | Wildcard

### Trottier 2110 (Session D)

#### Investigating Transformative Technology Integration through Lesson Analysis: A PICRAT Model Pilot Study

##### Research

Adjoa Mensah, Tina Vo, Peter Wiens & Vanessa Vongkulluksn | *University of Nevada Las Vegas*

##### Abstract

According to the Council for Accreditation of Teacher Preparation (CAEP), technology integration is an important component of instructional practice and competency standards. This quantitative pilot study evaluates preservice science lesson plans using the nine domains of the PICRAT model. In a university located in the southwest region of the US, researchers piloted the use of the PICRAT model as a metric for the frequency of technology integration occurrences. Coding for PICRAT domains (passive, interactive, creative, replacement, amplification and transformation) was triangulated among researchers using interrater reliability to ensure consistent coding. The researchers deliberated on the particular benefits and obstacles associated with the PICRAT model and offered perspectives on the feasibility of utilizing the domains to code lesson plans in teacher preparation. These findings suggest a high level of consistency among raters in evaluating different PICRAT domains, particularly in the latter four categories where

unanimous agreement was attained.

**5:00 - 7:00**

**See Congress Programming for Social Tent & Food Options**

**7:00 - 11:59 | OTESSA Social**

# Saturday, June 15

 Note!

In Person at McGill University

**8:00 - 9:00 | Continental Breakfast Provided**

**8:00-11:30 | Welcome Desk Open**

**9:00 - 9:15 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement**

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

**9:15 - 9:30 | Break**

**9:30-10:30 | Concurrent Session 13**

**Session 13.1 | Forthcoming**

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

**Session 13.2 | Sustaining Positive Change**

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

## What I Wish Someone had Told Me: Insights on building sustainable impact with open education

Terry Greene | *Trent University*

Apurva Ashok | *The Rebus Foundation*

Carley McDougall & Amanda Grey | *Kwantlen Polytechnic University*

Hugh McGuire | *Pressbooks*

### Abstract

Veteran leaders of groundbreaking open education projects and programs reflect on key lessons they have learned (and continue to learn) about community-building, establishing sustainable support systems, and demonstrating impact with open education. This session brings together visionary minds representing different contexts of open education, ranging from system-level initiatives and multi-institution collaborations to institution-level capacity-building and program-level learning design transformation that empowers students using open pedagogy. This session will facilitate organic dialogue between panelists and members of the audience using a modified, participatory “fishbowl” format. Tapping into the rich experience represented at OTESSA convenings, a portion of the panel session will use the “open fishbowl” format that invites audience members to tag into the discussion to ask questions, share comments or insights. This participatory session will surface the creativity and collective wisdom that come from sharing what we glean in failures and successes on the open education journey.

## Session 13.3 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

### Designing and Implementing a Framework to Centralize an Accessibility Resource Index Focusing on Teaching & Learning

Practice

Shehroze Saharan, Christopher Laursen & Sara Fulmer | *University of Guelph*

### Abstract

The Accessibility Resource Index project addresses the challenge of decentralized accessibility resources within educational institutions. This open-access initiative aims to centralize accessibility resources and streamline access for educators to vital information

on accessibility and accommodations. This project consists of two main components: (1) the Framework and the (2) Exemplary Model. Hosted on an Open Educational Resources (OER) Library, the Framework provides a clear guide for indexing accessibility resources, adaptable for any educational and professional needs. The Exemplary Model, developed using e-learning design software, serves as a practical example of the Accessibility Resource Index focusing on an Ontario post-secondary institution as a use-case. This not only demonstrates the index's application but also inspires other institutions to implement similar accessibility measures. By consolidating these resources into an OER, the project champions the democratization of knowledge and promotes more inclusive teaching practices. It represents a significant step towards reducing educational inequities and enhancing the accessibility of knowledge for faculty, instructors, and educational developers while simultaneously offering a scalable solution for broader educational challenges.

## **10:30-11:00 | Break**

## **11:00-12:00 | Poster Session**

Information forthcoming.

## **12:00 - 1:30 | Break**

## **1:30 - 2:15 | Concurrent Session 10**

### **Session 10.1 | Wildcard**

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

### **1:30 - 1:50 | Dangling in Between: Investigating the Impacts of Using AI in Higher Education Research**

Research

Todd Milford & Sara Fallahi | *University of Victoria*

### Abstract

Artificial intelligence (AI) is used in education since 2015 (Vincent-Lancrin & van der Vlies, 2020). Benefits and hindrances of using AI has been debated in many academic literature (Chen et al., 2020; Crompton & Song, 2021; Verma & Tomar, 2021). Today with the rise of AI tools which are available to the public, with students using them more, and universities clarifying their stance on the topic, investigating the impacts of using AI in education is more crucial than ever. The purpose of this paper is to investigate the impacts of using AI tools for graduate students. For this aim, participants were introduced to a few AI tools to use for writing literature review. Participants were also interviewed on their experience and opinion on using AI in research. Initial findings of this research suggest that the participants could benefit from using AI, for example in saving time while researching, although some concerns remained unsolved for them. The output of this research can be considered while integrating AI in higher education as well as policy making.

## **1:55 - 2:15 | OER in the context of generative AI**

### **Practice**

**Normand Roy** | *University of Montreal*

### Abstract

This proposal explores the transformation of OER in the context of Artificial Intelligence (AI), examining the multifaceted relationship between these two domains. While highlighting the potential benefits of AI in personalizing learning, creating new resources, and enhancing accessibility, the proposal also confronts the challenges associated with authorship and ethical considerations of AI-generated content. Focusing on strategies to navigate these challenges while ensuring the integrity of original contributions, the proposal further investigates how advanced AI techniques like fine-tuning and Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG) can be employed to create highly adaptive and personalized OER aligned with learners' needs. Additionally, it explores the potential of AI in generating multimodal resources, potentially overcoming language, literacy, and learning preference barriers to broaden access to education globally. Ultimately, this proposal aims to leverage AI while addressing its inherent challenges, ultimately enhancing the quality, accessibility, and adaptivity of OER.

## **Session 10.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching**

**Trottier 2110 (Session D)**

**1:30 - 1:50 | Undergraduate Students as Research Partners: Lessons Learned in a Scoping Review of Social Media in Teaching and Learning**

**Research**

**Emma Duke, Linh Bui, & Richard Hayman** | *Mount Royal University*

**i Abstract**

After 20+ years of educators incorporating various social media into their undergraduate teaching and learning, we have identified the need to critically examine the existing body of literature on social media integration in higher learning to understand how this use has been studied as well as how it informs today's teaching and learning processes. This presentation reports on our scoping review project exploring trends, gaps, and issues in the use of social media technologies in undergraduate teaching and learning contexts. The researchers, including two undergraduate student research partners, will refer to the project protocol (author3 & author4, 2023) and present initial findings and lessons learned during the project to-date. We will also discuss meta-research implications from these initial findings, including an exploration of partnering with undergraduate student RAs on a rigorous evidence synthesis project, with the latter delivered primarily from the perspective of the student partners.

**1:55 - 2:15 | Flexibility and Foresight in Ontario Postsecondary Education: Voices from the Field**

**Practice**

**Elisa Arnold, Rocio Chavez Telleria & Laura Viselli** | *eCampusOntario*

**i Abstract**

Flexibility has emerged as a key area to support digital transformation in postsecondary education, and educators are often at the forefront of implementation. To understand how educators are thinking and feeling, we engaged with 45 educators from Ontario's publicly-supported postsecondary institution through six virtual workshops using foresight methods to frame the conversations. Foresight is a formal, systematic way of thinking about the future, which offers a way to think about how the future might play out and expand the solution space. Specifically, we used the following foresight methods: Futures Triangle, to understand the interrelationships among future visions, present drivers of change, and past limitations; Causal Layered Analysis (CLA), to explore the assumptions that underlie the way we frame problems, situations, and solutions; and Three Horizons, to explore what would it take to transition from present situations to fu-

ture visions. This presentation is a summary of the research about these educators think and feel about flexibility in post secondary education, including considerations of equity and ethics and the application to practice, policy and infrastructure and recommended next steps.

## **2:15 - 2:45 | Break**

## **2:45 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 11**

Trottier 0070 (Session B)

### **Session 11.1 | Addressing Inequities**

#### **Challenging Stereotypes: The Role of The Matilda Project in STEM Gender Equality**

##### **Workshop**

Shehroze Saharan | *University of Guelph*

##### **i Abstract**

The Matilda Effect - a term coined by Yale historian Margaret W. Rossiter - is a phenomenon used to describe women scientists who have been ignored, forgotten, or denied credit due to sex-linked biases. The unfortunate reality is that the Matilda Effect is still prevalent today as women are not given due credit for their scientific achievements. The Matilda Project (<https://www.thematildaproject.com/>), a higher education initiative committed to shedding light on the pervasive issue of gender inequality in STEM, stands strategically poised to tackle this challenge. Positioned as an open-access resource, The Matilda Project encompasses the creation of educational videos and a website. The videos offer concise insights into key topics, while the website will host interactive activities and will serve as a comprehensive collection showcasing both historical and contemporary women scientists who share a common experience—the Matilda Effect.

### **Session 11.2 | Sustaining Positive Change**

Trottier 2100 (Session C)

## Empowering Student Voices: Integrating Stop-Motion Animation with Google Drawing, Canva, and Cap Cut

### Practice

Patricia Dennis | *Pride Academy Charter School*

#### Abstract

In designing Project Based Learning (PBL) curriculum and units that focus on real-world issues related to diversity, sustainability, and justice, students will create hands-on projects that evoke change within themselves, their communities, and globally. In this interactive and engaging in-person workshop, educators will be immersed in a comprehensive session focused on harnessing the potential of stop-motion animation using Google Draw, Canva, and Cap Cut. The central objective of this workshop is to empower educators with the expertise and tools to integrate the engineering design process into their teaching methods, fostering student creativity and innovation while amplifying their voices through modern technology. Throughout the workshop, participants will explore how to utilize Project-Based Learning (PBL) to sustain positive change and explore the UN Global Goals, aiming to equip educators with the necessary resources and strategies to facilitate meaningful learning experiences for their students.

## Session 11.3 | Addressing Inequities

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

2:45 - 3:45 | **Unleashing Potential: Exploring Open Education Initiatives with TRU Open Press**

### Practice

Danielle Collins, Marie Bartlett, Brenna Gray, Jessica, Kaitlyn Meyers, Jon Fulton, Natasha Ramroop Singh & Ananya Kamboj | *Thompson Rivers University*

#### Abstract

Join us at the OTESSA conference as we highlight the transformative impact of the Thompson Rivers University (TRU) Open Press. As proponents of open education, we aim to demonstrate how the TRU Open Press fosters a sustainable and inclusive future through innovative projects. Gain insights into our core operations, including our role as a leading provider in web-first publishing, open pedagogy, and scholarship. We'll delve into our proposal process, detail how projects are initiated and navigated, with the goal

of sustaining positive change for a diverse, sustainable, and democratic world. Experience the tangible impact of our initiatives through a showcase of successful projects in the evolving landscape of online learning. Explore our open publication strategies, funding mechanisms, and their profound impact on addressing inequities. Learn about our collaborations with faculty, students, Indigenous communities, and local organizations, all contributing to sustaining shared futures through education. Delve into the production processes of our Open Educational Resources (OER) and open pedagogy projects, fostering positive and meaningful change. Join us in shaping the future of education and scholarship through meaningful discussions and building connections for shared knowledge and inclusivity.

### **3:45 - 4:00 | Break with Coffee & Snack Provided**

### **4:00 - 4:30 | Concurrent Session 12**

#### **Session 12.1 | Addressing Inequity**

**Trottier 2100 (Session C)**

**Seeking a newer equity, diversity, and inclusion model for educators**

**Practice**

**Lorayne Robertson, Jessica Trinier & Roland Van Oostveen | *Ontario Tech University***

#### **i Abstract**

The complexities of the human condition are evident in myriad ways, yet human differences are used globally to deny basic rights. How differences are perceived in education impacts student access and participation in school, and ultimately the outcomes of their school experience. Courses on equity, diversity and inclusion are one means to help future educators become aware that the benefits of schooling are not equally available to all students. This paper presents a reflective description of a model used for the co-construction of equity, diversity and inclusion courses that employs a community of practice model where student voice features prominently in both course design and course enactment. The model relies on establishing a shared spirit of equity humility for learners and educators, and recognition of the need for student safety in potentially uncomfortable conversations. Basic human rights is an anchoring concept. While, in the past, the

teaching of equity has tended to focus on distinct aspects of oppression in society as individual topics, the co-construction of equity model relies, instead, on building bridges of understanding that cross oppressions. The concept of building cross-equity understandings is helpful as a guide to dismantling oppression and guiding the rebuilding of safer, more inclusive spaces in schools.

## Session 12.2 | Wildcard

### Trottier 2110 (Session D)

#### Investigating Transformative Technology Integration through Lesson Analysis: A PICRAT Model Pilot Study

##### Research

Adjoa Mensah, Tina Vo, Peter Wiens & Vanessa Vongkulluksn | *University of Nevada Las Vegas*

##### Abstract

According to the Council for Accreditation of Teacher Preparation (CAEP), technology integration is an important component of instructional practice and competency standards. This quantitative pilot study evaluates preservice science lesson plans using the nine domains of the PICRAT model. In a university located in the southwest region of the US, researchers piloted the use of the PICRAT model as a metric for the frequency of technology integration occurrences. Coding for PICRAT domains (passive, interactive, creative, replacement, amplification and transformation) was triangulated among researchers using interrater reliability to ensure consistent coding. The researchers deliberated on the particular benefits and obstacles associated with the PICRAT model and offered perspectives on the feasibility of utilizing the domains to code lesson plans in teacher preparation. These findings suggest a high level of consistency among raters in evaluating different PICRAT domains, particularly in the latter four categories where unanimous agreement was attained.

**5:00 - 7:00**

**See Congress Programming for Social Tent & Food Options**

**7:00 - 11:59 | OTESSA Social**

# **Part II**

## **Francais**

# Wednesday, June 12

 Note!

In Person at McGill University

**8:00 - 9:00 | Continental Breakfast Provided**

**8:00-11:30 | Welcome Desk Open**

**9:00 - 9:15 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement**

Trottier 0060 (Session A)

**9:15 - 9:30 | Break**

**9:30-10:30 | Concurrent Session 1**

**Session 1.1 | Addressing Inequities**

**Card Sorting as a Methodology for Discovering Underlying Needs of Communities Seeking to Develop Learning Spaces: Towards a Better Understanding of the Sociocultural Ecology**

Trottier 0060 (Session A) | Research

Marguerite Koole | *University of Saskatchewan*

Gordon Rugg | *Keele University*

Thiago Lemes de Oliveira | *Wolverhampton University*

**Valentina Arancibia** | *Federal University of Uberlândia*

**Redouane Touati.** | *Universidad Católica del Maule & Yahia Fares University, Médea*

## **i** Abstract

In this paper, we focus on a knowledge elicitation method called single-criterion card sorting. To begin, we will provide a background two of the communities with whom we have been working: a Deaf and Hard of Hearing community in Canada and a community in Algeria. After briefly describing the context of the project, we will provide a description of, rationale for, and challenges with card sorting as a preliminary method. Next, we will explain the card-sorting procedures, present the preliminary data, and explain the analysis procedures. Although there are many kinds of card sorting, we will guide participants through a hands-on exercise using single-criterion card sorting (using both digital and in person techniques). Participants will learn about text-based, image-based, and object-based options, when to use card sorting, how to collect data, and how to analyse card sorting data through visual-numeric ‘heat maps’ (co-occurrence matrices). We can share a free Java-based software tool for generating heat maps.

Put simply, the paper provides a discussion of the data and how the data will guide the selection of subsequent knowledge modelling methods that will guide further analysis and hopefully help to gain a better, in-depth understanding of the communities’ needs and aspirations that may otherwise remain hidden beneath social, cultural, and linguistic barriers. With careful selection of knowledge modelling methods, we hope to help limit bias and the perpetuation of English and Western ways of doing and knowing. Meaningful consultation and collaboration can help to ensure that the communities’ interests remain at the heart of the project(s) and reduce Western (‘outsider’) control of research, analysis, and development.

## **Session 1.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching**

**Evolving our understanding of technology-integrated assessment: A review of the literature and development of a new framework**

**Trottier 2100 (Session C) | Research**

**Colin Madland** | *University of Victoria*

**Valerie Irvine** | *University of Victoria*

**Christopher DeLuca** | *Queens University*

**Okan Bulut** | *University of Alberta*

## Abstract

In this paper, we review the literature on technology in assessment in higher education and compare how the literature aligns with the Assessment in a Digital World framework (Bearman et al., 2022). We found themes in the literature that were not present in the framework (e.g., academic integrity and faculty workload) and constructs in the framework not evident in the literature (e.g., future self and future activities). Additionally, we consider other gaps in both the framework and the literature evident in day-to-day practices and government legislation or mandates, such as considering legal or ethical aspects of duty of care and the integration of Indigenous worldviews. We then developed the Technology-Integrated Assessment Framework to help instructors and administrators consider a broader range of constructs when planning assessment strategies in technology-integrated learning environments and to serve as a basis for further investigation into how the different constructs within the framework contribute to how we design, implement, and teach about assessment in digital learning environments today. We present an introduction of this technology-integrated assessment framework, invite feedback from the OTESSA community, and discuss future research goals and opportunities.

## **Session 1.3 | Addressing Inequities**

### **Critical reflections on course materials: The rise of the single-use e-textbook and a university library's multi-pronged response**

#### **Trottier 2110 (Session D) | Research**

**Madelaine Vanderwerff & Sara Sharun** | *Mount Royal University*

## Abstract

A recent shift by higher education publishers from print to digital content has led to an increase in course instructors adopting digital textbooks and courseware that are rented or sold directly to students. These digital courseware systems are attractive for a number of reasons: they are customizable, contain integrated value-added features, and are often marketed as inclusive, accessible, and cost-saving. However, there is debate about the impact of these tools on student learning and success, and about the challenges they create for learners, including restricting, controlling, and monitoring access and use. Our library has undertaken a number of distinct but related initiatives to support faculty in transitioning away from commercial textbooks in their courses. In this session, we will share a number of initiatives that invite faculty to critically reflect on course material selection, raise awareness about the challenges of commercial textbooks, and offer support for transitioning to OER, freely available, or library-licensed materials in their courses.

This session will share findings from our research and collaboration with stakeholders on campus.

Participants will be invited to share their experiences and discuss the potential long-term impacts of, and responses to, the commercialization and commodification of learning materials on their campuses.

## **10:30-11:00 | Break**

## **11:00-12:00 | Concurrent Session 2 | Ethics in Design Showcase**

All Session 2 Showcases are in the Trottier Mezzanine

### **Showcase 2.1 | Sustaining Positive Change**

#### **Design of Learning Experiences for Cyranoids & Echoborgs**

**Amanda Tkaczyk** | *Independent Scholar*

#### **i Abstract**

Cyranoids are individuals whose communication is determined by another person in real time (Milgram S., 1992). Echoborgs, a subset of Cyranoids, are individuals whose communication is determined by artificial intelligent agents (Corti, K., & Gillespie, A., 2015). With the widespread adoption of generative artificial intelligence tools that will enable the next generation of Echoborgs with highly sophisticated tools to mediate their human-to-human interactions, we are thrilled to explore the design of educational experiences for Cyranoid and Echborg learners. This project will include instructional materials and tools to support the learning and professional development of Echoborgs in your classroom, community, and workplaces. Online attendees can review materials and interact with chatbots. In-person attendees will have the opportunity to engage with a kiosk of learning materials and practice their interactions with a live Echborg learner. This critical design project will present an exploration of how the future of education might adapt in response to AI-augmented & AI-dependent learners. We will explore themes of technology adoption, responsibility, ethics, equity, and care in this speculative educational design project.

## Showcase 2.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

### Artifacts from the Futures of Higher Education

Elisa Arnold, Rocio Chavez Telleria & Laura Viselli | *eCampus Ontario*

#### Abstract

How we think about the future informs the decisions we make today; however, it is sometimes difficult to imagine what the future might look like. Foresight is a discipline and methodology that helps us think systematically about possible ways the future might play out and expands the solution space. Experiential futures, a subset of foresight methodology, is a way to consider different possible futures by interacting with imagined objects or environments of the future and develops capacity for futures thinking.

The Research and Foresight team at eCampusOntario has created four artifacts, grounded in foresight methodology, capturing different ways one can think about technology in higher education. These artifacts are based on the team's foresight trend research and explore possible future roles of technology. To facilitate the discussion and support analysis, we will use a foresight informed discussion toolkit developed by our team. This workshop will introduce attendees to the methodology of experiential futures to advance their capacity for futures thinking.

## Showcase 2.3 | Addressing Inequities

### Generative Friction: A Chatbot Interface Experiment

Ben Taylor & Devon Mordell | *McMaster University*

#### Abstract

Faced with the rapid adoption of generative artificial intelligence (GAI) in everyday life, educators are working to envision the role of this technology and routinely navigating its ethical use. Although the broader social, cultural, and environmental costs of the technology are well-documented, they are normally obscured by digital user interface experiences that “just work.” The practice-based design exhibit we are proposing is a GAI chatbot application that intentionally disrupts the user interface with details about the effects of each text input and output beyond the surface of the computer screen. Drawing on critical interface analyses, speculative design methods, and an interrogation of dark design patterns, we will attempt to make visible the past and potential future effects of GAI, including resource consumption, exploitative labour practices, perpetuation of biases, and an increase in economic divides. During this session, we will demo the

application and then allow for full audience engagement with the exhibit as we speak to the documentation of our design process. Our intention is to introduce a thoughtful and generative friction into the chat interaction, reclaiming so-called malicious techniques (e.g., distraction, interruption, obfuscation, and shock) to playful and socially productive ends.

## Showcase 2.4 | Addressing Inequities

### Decolonizing Educational Design: Toward Justice by Design in Higher Education

Rebecca Sweetman & Yasmine Djerbal | *Queen's University*

#### Abstract

As institutions commit to strategic initiatives for justice in higher education, this session shares practical ways to walk the decolonial talk in the design of education. Delving into critical design as a transformative tool and pedagogy, we seek to shift how storytellers in higher education craft their narratives. This presentation confronts how we, practically, design an equitable future of learning, including the applied skills required to recognize and challenge our normative biases and design assumptions, and transform our day-to-day work in educational design.

Examining how to mitigate curricular harms and consider the ethics of educational technologies, we introduce a justice by design framework that strategically dismantles oppressive, racist, and colonial epistemologies that unconsciously make their way into course design. Through this presentation, we practice design justice principles and share an open professional training curriculum called “[Activist Design in Educational Multimedia](#)” as an opportunity for intervention. The curriculum employs theoretical and practical techniques to develop the competencies and confidence of educational design professionals to apply an anti-oppressive lens in their work. This session presents a multifaceted, practical, and principled approach to critical design that can be integrated across roles, disciplines, and hierarchies to re-story the process and outcomes of educational design.

**12:00 - 1:30 | Break**

**1:30- 2:30 | Keynote**

**Speaker Forthcoming**

**3:00 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 3 | Sustaining Positive Change**

**Trottier 0060 (Session A)**

**3:00 - 3:20 | Session 3.1**

**Supporting OER Adoptions through Federated Discoverability**

**Practice**

**Don Eldridge | *eCampus Ontario***

**i Abstract**

A key aspect of supporting OER adoption remains OER discoverability, which is commonly reported as a barrier to OER adoption as part of finding relevant resources and the time required to adopt (Belikov, & Bodily, 2016; Lantrip & Ray, 2021). This open data initiative includes the development of a metadata schema with crosswalks, technical configurations using Open Archives Initiative Protocol for Metadata Harvesting, and a collaborative pilot project to test and implement the technical solution. At the time of this proposal submission, the initiative is federating out the library metadata records to 24 post-secondary institutions. Lessons learned include working with consortiums and shared technology services, evaluating the value of federation for a wide range of post-secondary institutions, and the impact for future collaborations.

**3:25 - 3:45 | Session 3.2 | Sustaining Positive Change**

**Means to an End? Ethical Methodologies for Developing Ethical Facial Recognition Training Datasets**

**Research**

**Jin Sol Kim, Amanda Yu, Lai-Tze Fan & Tatum Weicker-O'Connor | *University of Waterloo***

## Abstract

In January of 2020, The New York Times published a report on the implications of Clearview AI's facial recognition system in law enforcement. However, unlike other discussions of facial recognition in this field, which focus on the consequences of racial biases within the system, this report revealed the problematic methodology behind the development of Clearview AI's robust training dataset, calling for an examination of ethics in the very process of creating ethical tech. Clearview AI has since been banned in countries including Canada for scraping over three billion photos from social media platforms, breaching privacy laws surrounding consent for use of personal data. Yet the challenge remains: how can we create a fair and robust training dataset for facial recognition algorithms given the resource-intensive nature of the task as well as complications such as the limitations of data privacy? How can we ensure that the means of creating ethical facial recognition technologies mirror its ends? With current rapid developments in generative AI, synthetic training datasets have newly emerged as a promising player in the field of facial recognition technologies. Training datasets such as Digi-Face 1M that are entirely composed of generated images seem to waive the need for ethical considerations altogether by skirting the use of human subjects. Nevertheless, insofar as the application of these tools affect human lives, we must question whether this new method of dataset development is truly free from ethical concerns.

**3:45 - 4:00 | Break**

**4:00 - 4:30 | Concurrent Session 4**

**Session 4.1 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching**

**Trottier 2100 (Session C)**

**Planning, living, and adding to our plates: : K-3 educators' experiences of curricula in Virtual Learning Environments (VLE)**

**Practice Melissa Bishop | *University of Prince Edward Island***

## Abstract

Virtual Learning Environments (VLE) have interested scholars since the late 20th century, with much of the research focusing on secondary and post-secondary instructors and learners (Brown, 2010; Dabbagh, 2007; Fuchs, 2014; Plump & LaRosa, 2017; Proserpio

& Gioia, 2007). With the onset of VLEs in elementary education due to the COVID-19 pandemic and the continuation of synchronous virtual learning thereafter, VLEs have become commonplace in K-3 contexts across Ontario. Yet, as we contend with the ubiquitous nature of technology in early elementary, a paucity of literature exists regarding teachers' and Early Childhood Educators' (ECE) experiences of planned and lived curricula (Muldong et al., 2021; Aperribai et al., 2020; Ferdig et al., 2020) in VLEs. Starting from standpoint epistemologies (Au, 2012; Harding, 1991; Haraway, 2003), reflecting on five narrative interviews, and employing a narrative analysis of field texts (Clandinin, 2006; Clandinin & Connelly, 1988, 1996, 2000), we unearthed six narrative threads: time, parent communication, relationship building, classroom community, engagement and teacher presence, and technological challenges. These six threads suggested how ECEs and teachers navigated the entanglements of planned and lived curricular experiences in VLEs. Further, the five threads exposed critical elements to be considered in future VLE policy and curricular reform in the K-3 context.

## Session 4.2 | Transitions of Online Learning and Teaching

### Tech-based teaching practices and student engagement from the perspective of self-determination theory

Trottier 2110 (Session D)

Géraldine Heilporn, Mourad Majdoub & Fatme Diab | *Université Laval*

#### Abstract

Teachers can enhance inclusion and provide personalized learning experiences for students by utilizing digital tools and prioritizing inclusive teaching methods (Kim et al., 2019). However, Cabellos et al. (2023) have argued that digital resources were used more to transmit information than to engage students in their learning. The widespread and necessary use of ICT has not served to make learning student-centered but was primarily aimed at the transmission and evaluation of the content. Thus, students' motivation and engagement are significantly affected, worsening the existing issues regarding low school motivation, especially in secondary school (Cai et al., 2022). In response to these research gaps, the aim of this communication is to explore high school teachers' technology-based teaching methods that motivate and address the needs of learners with the use of technology based on the digital divide framework (Van Dijk, 2020), SDT (Self-Determination Theory) (Ryan & Deci, 2017) and student engagement model (Archambault et al., 2019). We have conducted individual semi-structured interviews with high school teachers aiming to obtain in-depth qualitative data mainly through open-ended questions. A thematic analysis has been employed to inductively analyze the interview data and generate pos-

sible themes and categories based on the objectives of our study. The findings and recommendations for future research will be shared at OTESSA conference.

## **Session 4.3 | Sustaining Positive Change**

### **Open Learning Design in an Inquiry-based Educational Setting**

#### **Research**

**Trottier 0070 (Session B)**

**Maryam Shirdel Pour & Michael Paskevicius** | *University of Victoria*

#### **i Abstract**

Inquiry-based learning as a pedagogical approach encourages students to explore and investigate real-world problems and foster a deeper understanding of concepts as they actively connect new information to their existing mental frameworks (Martell, 2022). Educators are increasingly recognizing the value of creating an engaged learning environment that promotes collaboration and allows for personalized and meaningful learning experiences (Bui & Khoo, 2020). Inquiry-based learning may require that learners engage in networking beyond formal academic settings and connect with professionals, peers, and resources in various fields that could foster their deeper engagement with learning (Robert, 2022).

Open Educational Practices (OEP) tend to create cooperative teaching and learning practices in which the focus is on the role of the learners and the impact that their participation will have on the learning process and practice (Mayrberger, 2020; DeRosa & Robinson, 2017; Author. 2019). Students could benefit from the principles of OEP to engage in open and dynamic conversations to collectively build a deeper understanding of the subject and share their ideas and inquiry work widely while following copyright guidelines. This study, therefore, aspires to investigate the effects of incorporating OEP in an educational environment centred around inquiry.

**5:00 - 7:00**

**See Congress Programming for Social Tent & Food Options**

**7:00 - 11:59 | OTESSA Social**